

Cross-Organizational Governance Agreements for FAI

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This work derives from and formalizes the inter-Self coordination architecture introduced in “Inter-Self Coordination via Shared Substrate / Full Aspect Integration” (Li, April 2026), the third paper in the CKS theory series following “Coordination Outside the Model: A Human-Governed Substrate Pattern for AI Systems” (Li, April 2026) and “The Instinct/Reasoning Separation Outside the Model” (Li, April 2026).

Abstract

Full Aspect Integration (FAI) events between organizationally distinct Selves require governance at two levels: the level of the event (per-event configuration and records) and the level of the organizational relationship within which events recur. This note formalizes the second level — the cross-organizational governance agreement — as a five-component governance document maintained by each participating Self’s governance authority as home substrate content. The five components are: mutual governance standards (floors each party commits to maintaining), escalation governance framework (organizational instantiation of the escalate-to-humans commitment), audit rights and obligations (inter-organizational record access), agreement amendment protocol (bilateral governance of agreement change), and agreement termination governance (dissolution conditions and configuration consequences). The note states the relationship between the agreement and event-level configurations — the agreement informs but does not replace per-event and standing configurations — identifies the informal organizational relationship as the governing anti-pattern, and provides an operational test for whether a sustained FAI relationship is supported by a conforming cross-organizational agreement.

1. The governance gap above event-level configurations

FAI event configurations specify the governance of individual FAI events: sharing scope, cardinality, persistence policy, conflict-handling orchestration, escalation routing, and contribution record requirements for a specific event or class of events. Standing configurations (D2.21) establish reusable authoring-level governance for recurring FAI events, reducing per-event configuration work and stabilizing the governance patterns a sustained FAI relationship relies upon.

Both levels address the governance of FAI events. Neither addresses a prior and distinct question: what organizational-level commitments do two Selves’ governance authorities make to each other to

enable a sustained FAI relationship to exist at all?

This is the question D2.34 answers. The cross-organizational governance agreement is not a FAI event configuration and does not configure any specific event. It is the bilateral (or multilateral) governance document within which standing configurations and per-event configurations are authored — the organizational framework that establishes what each party can expect from the other before any specific event is configured.

D2.34 is the operational decomposition of two parent sub-commitments. D1.25 establishes that FAI configurations are substrate content authored under joint authority across participating Selves' governance. D1.26 establishes that at population scope, accumulated FAI events operate under joint authority across population-level governance perimeters. D2.34 formalizes the organizational instrument through which joint authority is made operable at the level of the inter-organizational relationship: the agreement under which governance authorities commit to each other and within which event-level joint authority operates.

2. The five components

A cross-organizational governance agreement is complete when it specifies all five of the following components. Agreements that omit components are incomplete and produce the governance fragility the anti-pattern section names.

Component 1 — Mutual governance standards

The agreement specifies the minimum governance standards each party commits to maintaining across its FAI contributions. These are floors, not ceilings. A party may exceed the minimums in its standing configurations or per-event configurations; it may not fall below them without triggering the amendment or termination provisions of the agreement.

The minimum standards specification covers four areas. First, provenance depth: the minimum number of provenance steps that contribution records must carry, expressed as a governance commitment that standing configurations must meet or exceed. Second, conflict registry completeness: the minimum requirement for conflict state documentation at the inter-Self perimeter — what classes of conflicts must be registered, in what form, and for what retention period. Third, exchange bounding verification: how each party verifies, as a governance commitment, that its FAI contributions remain within the exchange-bounded-to-reasoning-layer commitment Paper 3's architecture makes — that instinct-layer content does not cross the inter-Self perimeter. Fourth, contribution record requirements: the minimum form and retention period for contribution records that each party generates for FAI events in the relationship.

These mutual standards inform trust calibration between the parties. A governance authority calibrating how much to rely on another party's FAI contributions can reason about the floor below which those contributions' governance will not fall, because the other party has committed to it in the

agreement.

The mutual-standards component is the organizational implementation of governance quality commitment between FAI partners. It operationalizes D1.25's joint authority across participating Selves' governance at the commitment-registry level: the standards are not unilateral, they are mutually authored and mutually binding.

Component 2 — Escalation governance framework

Three-tier conflict handling within the shared substrate (Paper 3, Claim 3) includes escalation to humans across joint authority of participating Selves' governance as an architectural commitment. An event-level configuration specifies the escalation routing for that event: which humans, in what roles, with what authority, receive conflicts that survive the preserve and resolve tiers.

The escalation governance framework component of the cross-organizational agreement is the organizational instantiation of that escalation routing commitment. It specifies which organizational representatives from each party hold cross-perimeter governance authority — the authority to participate in joint governance decisions over conflicts escalated from shared substrates in this FAI relationship. It specifies the process by which those representatives reach joint governance decisions: meeting triggers, decision timelines, documentation requirements, and how joint decisions are recorded as substrate content in each party's home substrate.

The component does not replace event-level escalation routing specifications. Each standing configuration and per-event configuration still names its own escalation routing. The agreement's component is the organizational backing that makes those event-level routings coherent: it establishes, at the organizational level, that the named representatives have the authority their event-level roles require, and that the process for joint decisions is not improvised per-event.

Component 3 — Audit rights and obligations

The agreement specifies the inter-organizational audit rights each party holds over past FAI events in the relationship. These are reciprocal rights and obligations: each party has the right to request governance records from the other party for past FAI events, and each party has the obligation to provide them within specified timeframes.

The audit right covers governance records, not raw substrate content. What can be requested: contribution records, conflict registry entries, provenance depth records, exchange bounding verification records, and event configuration documents for specific past FAI events. What cannot be required: home substrate content beyond what the governance records cover, or records for events outside the FAI relationship governed by the agreement.

The timeframe obligation specifies the window within which the obligated party must respond to an audit request. This operationalizes path retraceability (Paper 1) at the inter-organizational level: the ability to retrace the governance path of a past FAI event is not dependent solely on the requesting

party's own records but extends, under the audit right, to the other party's governance records for the same event.

Component 4 — Agreement amendment protocol

The agreement itself is subject to change. The amendment protocol specifies how changes to the agreement are made: which representatives hold amendment authority on each side, what process governs the proposal and acceptance of amendments, and how the effective date of an amendment is established.

Amendments are bilateral (or multilateral) governance acts. A party may not unilaterally amend the agreement. Proposed amendments are proposed to the other party's amendment authority and are effective only upon acceptance. The amendment record — who proposed, who accepted, the content of the change, and the effective date — is itself governance content recorded in each party's home substrate copy of the agreement.

The amendment protocol also governs what happens to standing configurations that relied on agreement terms that are changed. Where a standing configuration specifies governance parameters that the original agreement's mutual standards permitted and the amended agreement's mutual standards no longer permit, the parties' amendment process must either grandfather the standing configuration, require its revision, or specify a transition period.

Component 5 — Agreement termination governance

The agreement specifies the conditions under which either party may terminate the relationship and the governance consequences of termination.

Termination conditions may include: mutual consent, unilateral withdrawal with specified notice period, material breach of mutual governance standards with specified cure period, or specified triggering events. The agreement is specific about which conditions require notice and which permit immediate termination, and what constitutes material breach versus minor deviation addressable by the amendment protocol.

Governance consequences upon termination govern three classes of items. First, active FAI events: events in progress at the moment of termination are completed under pre-termination terms, or halted with contribution records generated to the point of halting, per the agreement's specification. Second, standing configurations: standing configurations that named the terminated FAI relationship are decommissioned or placed in a suspended state in each party's home substrate as governance records. Third, retention of governance records: governance records for past FAI events in the relationship are retained by each party as home substrate content for the retention period specified in the agreement, even after termination.

3. Relationship to FAI configurations

The cross-organizational agreement and FAI event configurations operate at different levels and neither substitutes for the other.

The agreement is organizational-level governance. It commits each party to governance standards, establishes escalation channels and audit rights, and governs the agreement's own change and termination. It operates continuously across the FAI relationship — it is in effect before any specific event is configured and remains in effect after any specific event concludes.

Per-event configurations and standing configurations are authoring-level governance. They specify the governance of FAI events: sharing scope, merge configuration, conflict-handling orchestration, escalation routing, contribution record form. They must meet or exceed the agreement's mutual governance standards floors. They implement the escalation routing whose organizational backing the agreement's escalation governance framework provides.

The relationship is that the agreement sets conditions that event-level configurations must satisfy, and provides the organizational backing — the named representatives, the joint-decision process, the audit rights — that event-level configurations presuppose. A standing configuration that names an escalation contact is coherent as governance only if the agreement has established that the named contact holds the required cross-perimeter governance authority. An event-level provenance depth requirement is a governance commitment only if the agreement has established a floor that the parties have committed to maintaining.

The agreement also cannot substitute for event-level configurations. The agreement does not configure any FAI event — it specifies no sharing scope, no merge configuration, no conflict-handling orchestration for any event. Every FAI event in the relationship still requires its own event-level governance, whether through a standing configuration that applies to it or a per-event configuration specific to it. An agreement without event-level configurations beneath it is organizational framework without operational governance.

4. The agreement as home substrate content

The cross-organizational governance agreement, or a reference to it, is substrate content within each participating Self's home substrate. It is subject to each home perimeter's three rights — the right of that party's governance authority to inspect, modify, and override the agreement copy within its own home substrate. Each party maintains its own copy as home governance content.

The copies should be equivalent: the same five components, the same terms, the same effective dates. They are not jointly custodied — no shared repository external to both home substrates is required. Each party's copy is within its own home perimeter. The expectation of equivalence is enforced through the amendment protocol (Component 4), which requires bilateral acceptance of changes: a unilateral modification to one party's copy that is not reflected in a bilateral amendment produces a divergence that is itself a governance record and a potential breach of the agreement.

This architecture preserves each governance authority's three rights over its own copy while keeping the copies materially aligned through the bilateral amendment process. It means the agreement is not outside governance — it is substrate content, inspectable and modifiable by each party's governance authority, and the record of what the parties committed to is available to each party without dependency on the other party's systems.

5. Anti-pattern: the informal organizational relationship

The governing anti-pattern for D2.34 is the informal organizational relationship: recurring FAI participation between organizationally distinct Selves without a cross-organizational governance agreement.

In the informal organizational relationship, the five components are absent or improvised. Mutual governance standards are assumed rather than committed — each party applies its own internal standards to its FAI contributions without any organizational commitment to the other party about what those standards are. Escalation governance is improvised per event — when a conflict escalates, the parties negotiate who has authority and what process applies, without the organizational backing the agreement's escalation governance framework provides. Audit rights are undefined — when a party seeks governance records for a past event, whether the other party is obligated to provide them, in what form, and within what timeframe, is not established. Amendment and termination are unstructured — the relationship can be changed or ended without governance process, and the consequences for active and standing configurations are not pre-specified.

The informal organizational relationship produces governance fragility as a structural property. For low-frequency or low-stakes FAI events, the fragility may not surface immediately — improvised escalation and informal standards may suffice in practice for a time. For high-frequency or high-stakes FAI relationships, the governance fragility is a compounding liability: each event that relies on improvised escalation or unverified mutual standards is an event whose governance cannot be retraced to organizational commitments. At the moment a consequential conflict escalates or an audit is required, the absence of the agreement becomes the governance failure.

6. Operational test

A sustained FAI relationship between two or more organizationally distinct Selves is supported by a conforming cross-organizational governance agreement if and only if all of the following are true:

1. An observer can locate, within each participating Self's home substrate, a governance document — or a reference to one — that is identified as the cross-organizational governance agreement for this FAI relationship.
2. The document specifies, in Component 1, the minimum provenance depth, conflict registry completeness, exchange bounding verification, and contribution record requirements that each party commits to maintaining.

3. The document specifies, in Component 2, which organizational representatives hold cross-perimeter governance authority for escalated conflicts, and the process by which those representatives reach and record joint governance decisions.
4. The document specifies, in Component 3, what governance records each party may request from the other for past FAI events, and the timeframe within which the obligated party must respond.
5. The document specifies, in Component 4, the process and authority requirements for amending the agreement, and the consequences of amendment for standing configurations that relied on superseded terms.
6. The document specifies, in Component 5, the conditions under which either party may terminate the relationship and the governance consequences of termination for active events, standing configurations, and retained records.
7. The copies held in each party's home substrate are materially equivalent and each reflect the same amendment history.
8. Standing configurations and per-event configurations within the FAI relationship meet or exceed the mutual governance standards floors specified in Component 1.

A relationship that fails any of (1)–(8) is either governed by an incomplete agreement or governed by no agreement at all. In either case the relationship instantiates the informal-organizational-relationship anti-pattern at the failing component.

7. Conclusion

The cross-organizational governance agreement occupies the organizational level above FAI event configurations. Standing configurations govern recurring events at authoring level; per-event configurations govern individual events at execution level; the cross-organizational agreement governs the organizational relationship within which both operate. Its five components — mutual governance standards, escalation governance framework, audit rights and obligations, amendment protocol, and termination governance — establish the organizational conditions under which sustained FAI participation between distinct Selves is coherent as governance rather than merely operational.

The agreement's mutual governance standards are floors: they commit each party to minimums that standing and per-event configurations must meet, without capping upward governance quality. Each party maintains its own copy as home substrate content, separately custodied within its own home perimeter, with bilateral amendment discipline maintaining material equivalence across copies. The absence of the agreement — the informal organizational relationship — is the anti-pattern this note names and the operational test in §6 detects.

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